

AUTHOR SUBMISSION GUIDELINES FOR GIFON JOURNAL

“Eyes on Location: The Journal of GeoINSIGHT”
Official Journal of the Geospatial Intelligence Foundation
of Nigeria (GIFON)
(For Staff, Members & External Contributors)

1. Purpose of the Journal

Eyes on Location: The Journal of GeoINSIGHT is a peer-reviewed, policy relevant and practice driven journal dedicated to advancing geospatial intelligence (GEOINT), spatial data science, earth observation, national security, infrastructure intelligence, environmental monitoring, and location-based decision systems in Nigeria, Africa, and globally.

- The journal provides a platform for:
- GIFON staff and members
- Researchers and academics
- Government and industry professionals
- Security, infrastructure, and development experts

2. Eligible Contributors

Submissions are welcomed from:

- GIFON Staff
- Registered GIFON Members
- Fellows and Distinguished Associates
- External collaborators (by invitation or approval)

All submissions must reflect GIFON’s ethical, professional, and national interest standards.

3. Acceptable Topic Areas

Submissions must fall within or strongly relate to one or more of the following focus areas:

A. Core GEOINT & Spatial Intelligence

- ✓ Geospatial Intelligence Systems & Architecture
- ✓ Remote Sensing & Earth Observation
- ✓ GIS, Spatial Data Science & AI
- ✓ Cartography & Geovisualization
- ✓ Location-Based Services & Analytics

B. National Security & Intelligence

- ✓ Defense, Border Security & Surveillance
- ✓ Counter-terrorism & Crime Mapping
- ✓ Cyber-Geospatial Intelligence
- ✓ Critical Infrastructure Protection
- ✓ Disaster Risk Intelligence & Early Warning Systems

C. Governance, Policy & National Development

- ✓ GEOINT in National Planning & Policy
- ✓ Smart Cities & Digital Governance
- ✓ Electoral Mapping & Population Intelligence
- ✓ Climate, Environment & Resource Security
- ✓ SDGs, Infrastructure & Economic Intelligence

D. Technology, Innovation & Industry

- ✓ Geospatial Startups & Innovation Ecosystems
- ✓ Satellite Technology & Space Systems
- ✓ UAV/Drone Mapping Applications
- ✓ Big Data, Digital Twins & Digital Infrastructure
- ✓ Proprietary Systems & Indigenous Innovation

E. Education, Capacity Building & Ethics

- ✓ GEOINT Education & Workforce Development
- ✓ Professional Standards & Ethics
- ✓ Gender, Inclusion & Youth in GEOINT
- ✓ Policy, Legal & Institutional Frameworks

4. Article Types Accepted (Category & Description)

Original Research Articles

Empirical or theoretical research

Policy & Strategy Papers

National, sectoral or institutional policy insights

Technical Papers Systems

Methods, tools, innovations

Case Studies Applied

GEOINT projects & lessons

Review Articles

State-of-the-art or thematic reviews

Commentary & Opinion

Strategic thought leadership

5. Language & Writing Style

All submissions must be written in clear, professional English.

Writing must be:

- ✓ Objective
- ✓ Evidence-based
- ✓ Analytical, not promotional

Avoid:

- ✓ Political propaganda
- ✓ Commercial advertising
- ✓ Unverified security claims
- ✓ National interest, security sensitivity, and data protection must be respected.

6. Manuscript Length

<u>Article Type</u>	<u>Word Count</u>
Research Articles	4,000 – 7,000 words
Policy & Strategy Papers	3,000 – 5,000 words
Technical Papers	3,000 – 6,000 words
Case Studies	2,500 – 4,500 words
Commentary & Opinion	1,500 – 2,500 words
Reviews	1,500 – 3,000 words

Word count excludes abstract, references, tables, and figures.

7. Manuscript Structure & Format

All submissions should follow this order:

- i. Title of the Article
- ii. Author(s) Full Name(s)
- iii. Affiliation, Position, Institution, City, Country
- iv. Email (corresponding author)
- v. Abstract (150–250 words)
- vi. Keywords (4–6 keywords)
- vii. Main Body
- viii. Introduction
- ix. Background / Literature Review
- x. Methodology (if applicable)
- xi. Analysis / Discussion
- xii. Findings / Implications
- xiii. Conclusion
- xiv. Acknowledgements (if any)
- xv. References
- xvi. Appendices (if necessary)

8. Formatting Specifications

- File Format: Microsoft Word (.docx)
- Font: Times New Roman
- Font Size: 12 pt
- Line Spacing: 1.5
- Margins: 1 inch (2.54 cm) on all sides
- Page Numbers: Bottom center
- Headings: Properly structured (1.1, 1.2, etc.)
- Tables & Figures:
 - Must be numbered and titled
 - Source must be indicated
 - High-resolution images only

9. Referencing & Citation Style

The GIFON Journal adopts the APA (7th Edition) Referencing Style.

- In-text Citation Examples:
 - (Usman, 2024)
 - (National Bureau of Statistics, 2023)
 - (Smith & Johnson, 2022)

Reference List Examples:

Book:

Usman, A. A. (2024). Geospatial Intelligence and National Security in Nigeria. Abuja: GIFON Press.

Journal Article:

Johnson, T., & Lee, R. (2022). Satellite intelligence and urban security mapping. *International Journal of GeoINT*, 11(2), 45–62.

Website:

Geospatial Intelligence Foundation of Nigeria. (2024). National GEOINT policy framework. Retrieved from www.gifon.org.ng

All sources must be properly cited. Plagiarism is strictly prohibited.

10. Standards of Ethics and Originality

Submissions must be:

- Original
- Not under review elsewhere
- Free from plagiarism

Authors must:

- Declare conflicts of interest
- Acknowledge funding sources
- Obtain permission for copyrighted figures
- Security-sensitive information must not compromise national safety.

11. Peer Review Process

All submissions undergo double-blind peer review.

Possible decisions:

- Accepted
- Accepted with minor revisions
- Revise and resubmit
- Rejected
- Editorial decisions are final.

12. Submission Process

Submissions should include:

- Manuscript file (.docx)
- Author bio (100–150 words)
- Signed Author Declaration Form

Submissions are sent to:

- editorial@gifon.org.ng (or official submission portal)

13. Copyright & Publication Rights

Authors retain intellectual ownership.

- GIFON retains:
- First publication rights
- Digital and print distribution rights
- Reproduction elsewhere must cite the GIFON Journal.

14. Special Note for GIFON Staff & Members

Institutional contributors are encouraged to:

- Align articles with GIFON programs and working groups
- Address national development priorities
- Support policy implementation and strategic intelligence growth